OSHA Rigging Inspection Checklist (29 CFR 1926.251)

For use before lifts on each shift and at the daily pre-use sling inspection.

OSHA 29 CFR 1926.251

DATE	SHIFT
INSPECTOR	AREA / EQUIPMENT ID

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A; use N/A only for gear or sling types not in use on the job.
2. Remove any sling or rigging item marked Defect from service at once and note what was found on this sheet.
3. The manufacturer's instructions, site rules and the full text of 29 CFR 1926.251 may add checks to this list.

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1926.251: Rigging equipment for material handling (Part 1926 Subpart H) Source: eCFR, Title 29, text as of 2026-11-09
Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1926-251-rigging-equipment-material-handling

SECTION A | General rigging, markings and inspections

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	Pre-shift rigging inspection Ref. 1926.251(a)(1)	All rigging equipment for this shift was inspected before use; no defective gear is in use.	☐	☐	☐	
2	Daily sling inspection Ref. 1926.251(a)(6)	A competent person named by the employer checked each sling, fastening and attachment for damage or defects today before first use.	☐	☐	☐	
3	Damaged slings out of service Ref. 1926.251(a)(6)	No damaged or defective sling is in use or available for use.	☐	☐	☐	
4	Safe working load marking Ref. 1926.251(a)(2)(i)	Each piece carries a permanent, readable manufacturer marking stating its safe working load.	☐	☐	☐	
5	Unmarked rigging Ref. 1926.251(a)(2)(iii)	No rigging without an affixed, readable identification marking is being used.	☐	☐	☐	
6	Load against marking Ref. 1926.251(a)(2)(ii)	The planned load is at or below the marked safe working load.	☐	☐	☐	
7	Idle rigging Ref. 1926.251(a)(3)	Rigging not in use is cleared from the immediate work area and is not a hazard to employees.	☐	☐	☐	
8	Custom lifting accessory marking Ref. 1926.251(a)(4)	Custom grabs, hooks, clamps or similar accessories show their safe working loads.	☐	☐	☐	
9	Custom accessory proof test Ref. 1926.251(a)(4)	Each custom accessory was proof-tested to 125 percent of its rated load before first use.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION B | Alloy steel chain slings

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
10	Chain sling identification Ref. 1926.251(b)(1)	Durable, permanently attached tag shows size, grade, rated capacity and sling manufacturer.	☐	☐	☐	
11	Chain attachments Ref. 1926.251(b)(2)	Hooks, rings, links and couplings are rated at least as high as the chain.	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION B | Alloy steel chain slings

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
12	Makeshift fittings Ref. 1926.251(b)(3)	No job- or shop-made hooks or links and no makeshift fasteners formed from bolts or rods.	☐	☐	☐	
13	Chain load Ref. 1926.251(b)(4)	Load does not exceed the working load limit on the sling's identification.	☐	☐	☐	
14	Link wear Ref. 1926.251(b)(5)	Wear at every point of every link is within Table H-1, e.g. no more than 5/64 inch on 3/8-inch chain.	☐	☐	☐	
15	Periodic thorough inspection Ref. 1926.251(b)(6)(i)	Last thorough inspection is within the interval the employer set for this sling and no more than 12 months ago.	☐	☐	☐	
16	Chain inspection record Ref. 1926.251(b)(6)(ii)	A record shows the most recent month this sling was thoroughly inspected and can be produced for examination.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION C | Wire rope slings

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
17	Wire rope sling tag Ref. 1926.251(c)(16)	Tag gives size, rated capacity per hitch type with its angle, and leg count on multi-leg slings.	☐	☐	☐	
18	Broken wires and wear Ref. 1926.251(c)(4)(iv)	In any length of eight rope diameters, visible broken wires are no more than 10 percent of all wires; no excessive wear, corrosion or other defect.	☐	☐	☐	
19	Splice strand ends Ref. 1926.251(c)(2)	Protruding strand ends in splices are covered or blunted.	☐	☐	☐	
20	Eyes Ref. 1926.251(c)(4)(iii)	Eyes in slings, bridles and bull wires are not made with wire rope clips or knots.	☐	☐	☐	
21	Knots Ref. 1926.251(c)(3)	Wire rope is not secured by knots; the only exception is haul back lines on scrapers.	☐	☐	☐	
22	Kinks Ref. 1926.251(c)(7)	Sling legs are straight with no kinks.	☐	☐	☐	
23	Shortening Ref. 1926.251(c)(6)	Slings are not shortened with knots, bolts or other makeshift devices.	☐	☐	☐	
24	Heat exposure Ref. 1926.251(c)(14)	No fiber core wire rope sling has been exposed to temperatures over 200 °F.	☐	☐	☐	
25	Welded end attachment certificate Ref. 1926.251(c)(15)(ii)	A proof-test certificate for welded end attachments is on file and available.	☐	☐	☐	
26	Sharp load edges Ref. 1926.251(c)(9)	Slings are padded or protected where they bear on sharp load edges.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION D | Fiber rope and synthetic web slings

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
27	Fiber rope sling marking Ref. 1926.251(d)(7)	Marking states rated capacity per hitch and angle, fiber material, and number of legs on multi-leg slings.	☐	☐	☐	
28	Fiber rope condition Ref. 1926.251(d)(6)	No abnormal wear, powdered fiber between strands, broken or cut fibers, uneven strand size or roundness, discoloration, rot or distorted hardware.	☐	☐	☐	

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SECTION D | Fiber rope and synthetic web slings						
No.	**Check item**	**What to look for**	**OK**	**Defect**	**N/A**	**Notes**
29	Fiber rope end attachments Ref. 1926.251(d)(5)	End attachments touching the rope have no sharp edges or projections.	☐	☐	☐	
30	Web sling marking Ref. 1926.251(e)	Marking or code shows manufacturer name or trademark, rated capacities for the hitch type, and material type.	☐	☐	☐	
31	Webbing Ref. 1926.251(e)(3)	Uniform thickness and width; selvage edges not split.	☐	☐	☐	
32	Web sling fittings Ref. 1926.251(e)(4)(ii)	Fittings have no sharp edges that could damage the webbing.	☐	☐	☐	
33	Web sling damage Ref. 1926.251(e)(8)	No acid or caustic burns, melted or charred areas, snags, punctures, tears, cuts, broken or worn stitches or distorted fittings.	☐	☐	☐	
34	Nylon chemical exposure Ref. 1926.251(e)(6)(i)	No nylon web sling is in use around acids or phenolics in any form (fume, vapor, spray, mist or liquid).	☐	☐	☐	
35	Polyester and polypropylene chemical exposure Ref. 1926.251(e)(6)(ii)	Polyester and polypropylene web slings are kept away from caustics in any form.	☐	☐	☐	
36	Aluminum fittings and caustics Ref. 1926.251(e)(6)(iii)	No web sling with aluminum fittings is used where caustics are present.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION E | Shackles and hooks						
No.	**Check item**	**What to look for**	**OK**	**Defect**	**N/A**	**Notes**
37	Shackle load Ref. 1926.251(f)(1)	Load is within the rated capacity marked on the shackle.	☐	☐	☐	
38	Hook safe working load Ref. 1926.251(f)(2)	Hook safe working load is taken from the manufacturer's recommendations for that size and type.	☐	☐	☐	
39	Hooks without manufacturer data Ref. 1926.251(f)(2)	Tested to twice the intended safe working load before first use.	☐	☐	☐	
40	Hook test record Ref. 1926.251(f)(2)	Dates and results of each hook test are recorded and kept.	☐	☐	☐	

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DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE?	☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service	
INSPECTOR SIGNATURE		DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW		DATE / TIME

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